

Meeting 2 - Patrick, Gala Longford

30 April 2026 | In-person | 2nd meeting (1st was online)

System: RS Back Office 5 (Retail Solutions)

What We Showed Him

We demonstrated 4 sections of RetailGuard:

- **Dashboard** - KPI cards, morning report view
- **Issues/Insights** - margin leakages, price anomalies, flagged items
- **Departments** - margin breakdown by department
- **Invoice Scanner** - OCR scan of non-approved supplier invoices

Demo order: Dashboard > Issues > Insights > Invoice Scanner > Patrick showed us his system

Patrick's Reactions

Invoice Scanner - STRONGEST reaction

"Nobody does this. People have tried this, but nobody could."

He loved the invoice scanner. The setup worked - referencing his pain from meeting 1 made the solution land harder. No more manual input was the key emotional trigger.

Margin Monitoring - Important but undersold

He talked about margins for 7+ minutes straight. He was showing us on his system where the red flags appear. But we didn't convey the monetary value well enough. Co-founder: "The margin is costing him hundreds of thousands, but he's not seeing that value because we didn't describe it to him well enough."

Dashboard - Wants redesign

Wants a list of 50 items where the margin doesn't make sense - margin leakages front and centre. Everything else secondary.

Departments - Wants sub-categories

Departments within departments. Example: Snacks > Crisps > specific types. Like folders within folders - wants margin info at every level.

Price Anomalies - Didn't understand the term

When asked directly, he said no. Rename to "Items Below Target Margin" or "Margin Alerts".

New Requirements from Patrick

1. Sub-category hierarchy

Department > Sub-department > Product level. Example: Snacks > Crisps > Tayto. Wants margin info at every level. PRIORITY: HIGH

2. Invoice product matching

After scanning, check if products exist in his system. Currently uses barcode scanner manually. Products NOT in system = flagged RED. Products IN system = update quantity. PRIORITY: HIGH

3. New product onboarding

After scan identifies NEW products: add to database with quantities? Need to scope import flow. PRIORITY: HIGH

4. Dashboard redesign

First view: ~50 items below target margin. Everything else secondary. Drill into departments. PRIORITY: HIGH

5. RS Back Office 5 integration

Make changes FROM RetailGuard that sync to RS Back Office. He offered system access. Also mentioned CBE (doesn't use it). PRIORITY: MEDIUM

6. Backend tracking

Track CSV uploads, invoice scans, usage patterns before sharing live link. PRIORITY: MEDIUM

7. Invoice scanner consistency

Must work across different formats. S&W Wholesale sample must be tested. PRIORITY: HIGH

8. Rename Price Anomalies

To "Items Below Target Margin" or "Margin Alerts". PRIORITY: HIGH - tiny effort.

Patrick's Business Context

- **Time shift:** Started 80% shop floor, 20% back office. Now flipped - 80% back office.
- **Belief:** "The real money is made in the back office"
- **Values time:** If something cuts even 20% of back office time, he's interested
- **Vendors:** Mentioned something - not fully captured, need to follow up
- **Self-checkout:** Brief mention - may have self-checkout, need to clarify
- **Red invoices:** Unrecognised products show RED or he circles them manually

Relationship Status

Patrick is now a co-development partner:

- Said "let's find ways to work together"
- Wants constant communication, not feature dumps every 2 weeks
- Offered access to his back office systems
- Wants to meet in 2 weeks with clear progress update
- Emotionally invested - committed to working with us

Lessons Learned

What went well

- Invoice scanner was the star
- Setting up the pain before showing solution worked
- Got real data: department list, sample invoice, system details
- Patrick is now a committed partner

What to improve

- One pain, one solution, let him talk. $A + B = C$, not ABCDEFG
- Treat him like he's seeing it for the first time
- Attach monetary value to each feature before showing it
- Show the raw CSV first to ground him
- Agree on demo order in advance
- Practice with someone first - dry run with family
- Watch sales/marketing videos - both study and share
- Need a Windows computer for RS Back Office testing
- Meet up earlier - not 4 hours before on the phone

Action Items Before Next Meeting (2 weeks)

- [Immediate] Rename "Price Anomalies" to "Margin Alerts" throughout app
- [This week] Test S&W Wholesale invoice against parser
- [This week] Redesign dashboard - margin leakages as primary view
- [Week 1-2] Build sub-category hierarchy (dept > sub-dept > product)
- [Week 1-2] Add product matching to invoice scanner
- [Week 1] Research RS Back Office 5 - API, integration options
- [After backend] Send Patrick the Cloudflare link
- [This week] Follow up with Patrick on vendors question
- [This week] Clarify self-service checkout mention
- [Before meeting] Practice demo with family member
- [Ongoing] Watch and share sales/marketing videos
- [Before integration] Get a Windows computer for RS Back Office testing

"Nobody does this. People have tried this, but nobody could."

- Patrick, on the invoice scanner